

Call for Expressions of Interest

<i>Date of Issue:</i>	September 2026
<i>Expected Completion Date:</i>	May 2027
<i>Project Title:</i>	ReflectAI: An Interactive Platform for Critical Engagement with AI-Generated Images
<i>Company:</i>	UoN

Contact Details

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Additional Info

<i>Students must sign NDA:</i>	☐
<i>Project uses personal data:</i>	☐
<i>Custom hardware required:</i>	☐
	If Applicable: Please provide details
<i>Relevant research areas (if applicable)¹:</i>	Human-Computer Interaction, Responsible AI

Project Background Information

Background

This project builds upon "CulturAI", a prior research project in which our team developed a process to evaluate cultural representation in AI-generated images (e.g. cultural stereotypes, cultural items represented well, emotional reactions to the images, etc.).

A website was built to disseminate findings from the project; this included a proof-of-concept interactive tool for users to evaluate the images generated in the project by themselves. See "Try it yourself" section: <https://culturai-develop.streamlit.app/>

Project website: <https://sites.google.com/view/culturaiproject>

Project specifications

Inspired by the CulturAI project, this Software Engineering project broadens the scope to allow people to reflect on how they experience and interpret AI-generated images, beyond only cultural representation. People often have

¹ An overview of different research areas in the school of computer science can be found [here](#).

strong reactions to AI-generated images, yet there is limited understanding of what drives these responses and how individuals interpret and evaluate AI-generated images.

This project will involve the design and development of an interactive web platform that supports collection, reflection and evaluation of AI-generated images. Cultural representation could remain an important application area, but the platform should be flexible enough to support people's views on other areas, such as authenticity, realism, misinformation, emotional impact, etc. The focus and scope of the platform will also be shaped by the interests of and suggestions made by the team members. What do you care about when you encounter AI-generated images online or in the real world? How do you feel about them? What do you consider 'AI slop' and why?

My proposal of what the platform could include:

- A "Research Mode" that will function as a crowdsourcing platform for Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) studies, allowing researchers to create image-based tasks, collect images, ratings and qualitative feedback, in order to investigate how people perceive and interpret AI-generated imagery (for example, allowing us to conduct a future study asking people to submit examples of 'AI slop' they encounter in their daily life and details about each image such as why they consider it slop). This part of the system doesn't have to 'look pretty', but it must be easy to use, robust and comply with ethical considerations followed when collecting data for research purposes. An admin user (researcher) and end-users (participant) roles should be considered.
- A "Public Engagement Mode" that will offer a game-like experience that encourages exploration and reflection through quizzes or image comparisons without storing research data. This could be used as a demo at public facing events. This mode could integrate the CulturAI activity (e.g. a game about evaluating cultural representation). This part of the system must be visually appealing, engaging and intuitive.

Students will employ user-centred design and software engineering practices to create a secure, accessible, and robust platform capable of supporting research and/or outreach activities.

The proposed project presents challenges in interaction design, ethical data management, participant engagement, content administration, and potentially dual-purpose system architecture.

The final focus and scope of the interactive platform will be determined and agreed by me and the project team within the first month of the project.

The resulting system should support research and/or public engagement activities, providing an interactive tool for understanding how people make sense of AI-generated images and their growing role in everyday life.

Requirements	
<i>The group must provide:</i> The final deliverables: • An interactive web platform that allows people to critically examine AI-generated images, that can support research and/or public engagement activities. • A user guide or manual • A handover plan for the end of the project When bidding, you should provide: • a strong justification of why this project interests you, • some initial ideas of what aspects of the platform the team would like to focus on (e.g. research mode, public engagement mode, both modes separately, a combination of both).	
Skills	
<i>Highly desirable:</i> Interest in the social impacts of AI Experience with or interest in Human-Computer Interaction	<i>Desirable:</i> Web development UX design Database design and management
Submission / Award information	
<i>Date of Submission:</i>	September 2026
<i>Date of Pitch:</i>	October 2026
<i>Notification of award:</i>	October 2026

For further information on this proposal, the team representative should in the first instance e-mail the lead contact stated above at the e-mail address provided.